Skippy for Android User Guide

Install and use the Skippy phone app - app version 1.19.1

Skippy for Android puts the Skippy group video calls on your phone: log in, join rooms of up to 10 people, call one person directly, chat and send files. It is a **client only** - it connects to the same Skippy server your desktop app uses, so you need that server's address and an account on it.

What you need

- An Android phone, **Android 7.0 or newer**, with a camera and microphone.
- The **server address** from whoever runs your Skippy server, for example **100.64.0.10:8470**.
- If that address starts with **100.** it is a Tailscale address: install the **Tailscale** app on the phone, sign in to the same account as the server and switch it on. Without it the phone cannot reach the server.
- The file **Skippy-Android-1.19.1.apk** from the **latest release** at github.com/lrizio/Skippy/releases (the one release page holds the files for every platform).

> **Not from the Play Store.** This app is installed by hand ("sideloading"). Android will warn you about installing from outside the store - that is normal. Only install the file from the official release page.

Install - choose one method

Method A: install on the phone itself (easiest)

1. On the phone, open the browser and go to **github.com/lrizio/Skippy/releases**. Open the **latest release** and tap **Skippy-Android-1.19.1.apk** in its list of files to download it.
2. When the download finishes tap **Open** (or find it in the **Files** or **Downloads** app and tap it).
3. Android says it can't install apps from this source: tap **Settings** and switch on **Allow from this source** for the browser or Files app you used, then press Back.
4. Tap **Install**. If Google Play Protect says it hasn't seen the app before, tap **More details**, then **Install anyway**.
5. Tap **Open**. Skippy is now in your app list too.

Method B: install from a Windows PC over USB with adb

Useful if you also do development, and the best way to update later (one command).

1. On the phone open **Settings, About phone** and tap **Build number** seven times to unlock Developer options. Then open **Settings, System, Developer options** and switch on **USB debugging**.
2. Connect the phone to the PC with a USB cable. Unlock the phone and tap **Allow** on the "Allow USB debugging?" prompt (tick *Always allow*).
3. On the PC, with the Android **platform-tools** installed, open a command prompt in the folder with the APK and run:

```
adb devices
adb install -r Skippy-Android-1.19.1.apk
```

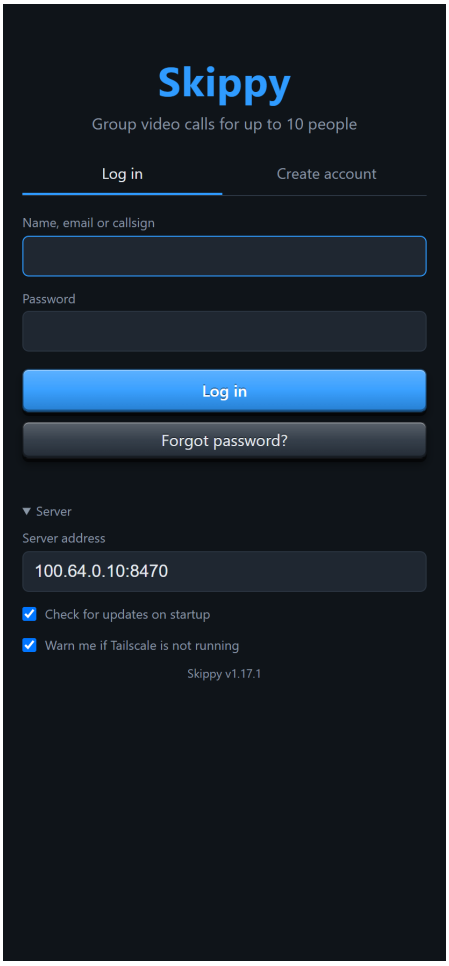
adb devices must list your phone as *device*; **Success** means it installed. **-r** keeps your login and settings when you update.

Method C: copy the file over USB

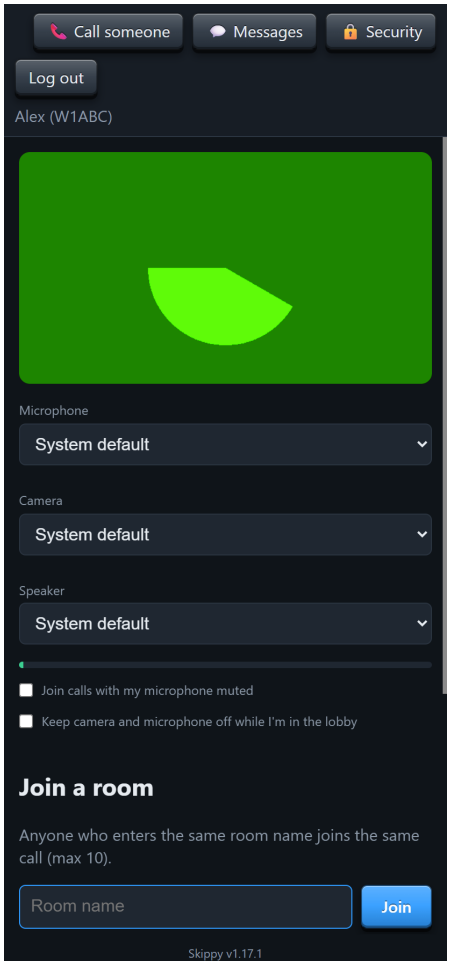
Download the APK on the PC, connect the phone with a cable, choose **File transfer** in the USB notification, copy the APK to the phone's **Download** folder, then open it from the **Files** app and continue from step 3 of Method A.

First start

1. Open **Skippy**. On the login screen open **Server** and type the server address (the **ws://** at the front is optional).
2. New here? Tap **Create account**, fill in name, email, optional callsign and a password of 8 or more characters. Existing account: log in with your name, email or callsign.
3. Skippy shows a **recovery key** once - save it somewhere safe. It is the only way back in if you forget your password.
4. When Android asks to let Skippy use the **camera** and **microphone**, allow both (while using the app is enough).



Enter the server address under **Server**.

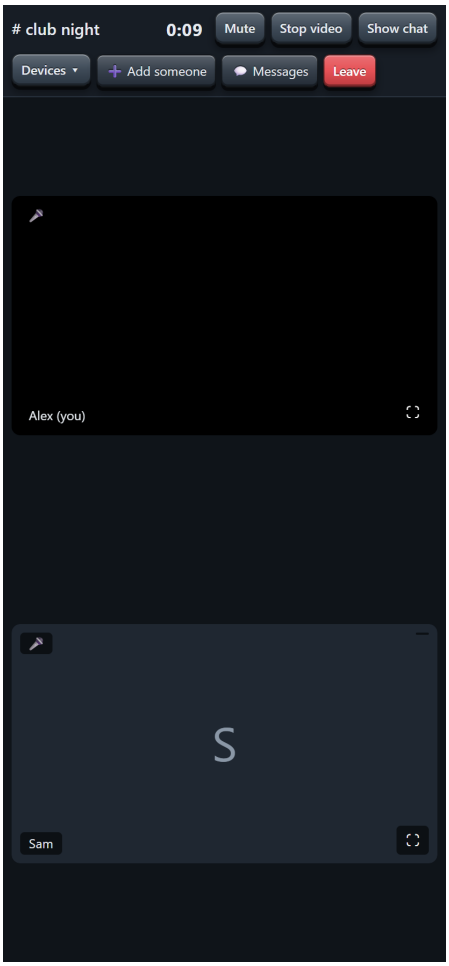


The lobby: preview, devices, room name and who is online.

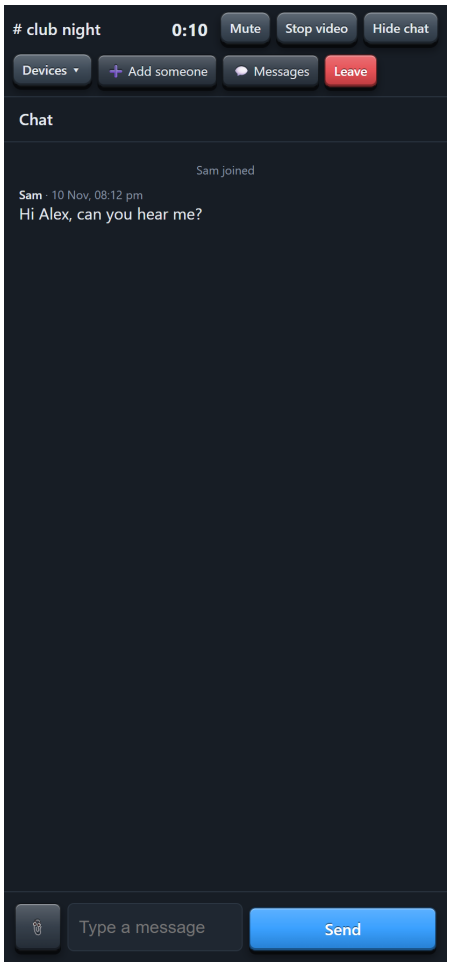
If you turned on a two-step code (authenticator app) on the desktop, the phone asks for it after your password. To set it up from the phone, open **Security** in the lobby: instead of a QR code it shows the secret and an **Open in my authenticator app** link.

Using Skippy on the phone

To do this	Do this
Join or start a room	Type a room name in the lobby and tap **Join**, or tap a room in the open or recent lists.
Call one person	Tap **Call someone** (lobby) or **Add someone** (in a call) and pick them from the list.
Mute / camera off	**Mute** and **Stop video** at the top of the call screen.
Pick or switch camera and microphone	**Devices** in the call (or the lists in the lobby): choose the front or back camera.
Fill the screen with one person	Double-tap their tile, or tap the corner button on it.
Chat	**Show chat** opens the chat over the call; **Hide chat** brings the video back.
Send a file	In the chat tap the paperclip and choose a file. Everyone in the call at that moment receives it.
Save a received file	Tap **Save** next to the file; it goes to **Documents/Skippy** on the phone.
Leave	Tap **Leave**.



In a call: video tiles fill the screen, controls on top.



Chat opens over the call.

Keep Skippy open on the screen during a call. The screen stays awake while you are in a call. The phone version has no background mode, and it **does not ring when the app is closed** - people can call you only while Skippy is open.

Different from the desktop app

- No **screen sharing** and no **call recording / transcripts** on the phone.

- No window arranging: video tiles are laid out automatically.
- No Tailscale warning banner - the phone can't check Tailscale for you, so turn it on yourself.

Updating

Download the newer APK and install it over the old one (Method A, or **adb install -r**); your login and settings are kept. If Android says **App not installed** or a conflict, the new file was signed with a different key: uninstall Skippy first (you will need to log in again) and install the new one.

Troubleshooting

Problem	What to try
"Could not reach the server"	Turn on **Tailscale** on the phone and make sure it shows connected. Check the address and port (for example 100.64.0.10:8470) and that the server program is running on its PC.
No video or sound from me	Settings, Apps, Skippy, Permissions: allow **Camera** and **Microphone**. Also check **Mute** and **Stop video** aren't on.
I can't hear others	Raise the media volume; check the phone isn't on silent or routed to a Bluetooth device.
Install blocked	Allow **Install unknown apps** for the browser or Files app you opened the APK from (Method A, step 3). If Play Protect blocks it, choose **Install anyway**.
A received file can't be saved	Tap **Save** again; files go to **Documents/Skippy** (or the app's own storage folder if Android refuses). Very large files are best received on the desktop app.
Forgot my password	Use **Forgot password?** on the login screen with your recovery key.

Skippy for Android shares its code with the desktop app (v1.19.1); the desktop User Guide covers accounts, rooms and the server in more detail. Source and releases: github.com/lrizio/Skippy.